



Name: _____ Cohort/Batch: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____

.NET PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 Q&A on CLR, GC, async/await, LINQ, generics, and testing

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What is the CLR and how does JIT compilation work in .NET?

Threat Model

Q6 What is the difference between a value type and a reference type in .NET?

Observability

Q2 What is the difference between .NET Framework, .NET Core, and .NET 5+?

Architecture

Q7 Why are generics preferred over object-based collections in .NET?

Lifecycle

Q3 How does the .NET Garbage Collector manage object generations?

Configuration

Q8 What is Span<T> and when should you use it?

Compliance

Q4 How does async/await work in .NET and what does ConfigureAwait(false) do?

Hardening

Q9 How does the .NET dependency injection container work?

Testing

Q5 What is LINQ and what is deferred execution?

SSO / IdP

Q10 How do you write unit tests in .NET with xUnit and Moq?

Tuning



ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 The Common Language Runtime is the

Mitigation

The Common Language Runtime is the virtual machine that executes .NET code. Source is compiled to CIL (Common Intermediate Language). At runtime the JIT compiler translates CIL to native machine code on first execution. The result is cached for subsequent calls.

A6 Value types (struct, int, bool, DateTime)

Observability

Value types (struct, int, bool, DateTime) are stored inline in the stack or in the object containing them. Reference types (class) store a pointer on the stack; the object lives on the heap. Assigning a value type copies data; assigning a reference type copies the pointer.

A2 .NET Framework (Windows only, ships with

Primitives

.NET Framework (Windows only, ships with Windows). .NET Core (cross-platform, performant, open-source, side-by-side). .NET 5+ unified both into a single cross-platform platform with yearly releases. .NET Framework still exists for legacy Windows apps but receives only security patches.

A7 List<int> stores ints directly without boxing.

Automation

List<int> stores ints directly without boxing. List<object> boxes each int into a heap-allocated object, adding GC pressure and casting overhead. Generics are also type-safe: the compiler rejects List<string>.Add(42) at compile time without a runtime cast.

A3 Objects start in Gen0 (collected frequently,

Hardening

Objects start in Gen0 (collected frequently, cheaply). Objects that survive Gen0 are promoted to Gen1, then Gen2. Large objects (>85 KB) go directly to the Large Object Heap and are collected with Gen2. Shorter-lived Gen0 collection pauses are the fastest.

A8 Span<T> is a stack-allocated view of

Governance

Span<T> is a stack-allocated view of a contiguous memory region (array, string, native memory). It enables sub-slice operations without allocation: span.Slice(5, 10) does not copy. Use it in hot parsing code (HTTP headers, CSV rows) to eliminate allocations.

A4 await suspends the method and returns

Gotchas

await suspends the method and returns a Task. When the awaited operation completes, execution resumes on the original SynchronizationContext by default (e.g., UI thread). ConfigureAwait(false) skips context capture, avoiding deadlocks in library code.

A9 Register services with

Assessment

Register services with builder.Services.AddSingleton<IFoo, Foo>(). The container builds a ServiceProvider that resolves constructor parameters recursively. Call provider.GetRequiredService<IFoo>() or let the framework inject via constructor injection in controllers and services.

A5 LINQ provides a query syntax over

Federation

LINQ provides a query syntax over any IEnumerable<T>. Deferred execution means the query is not evaluated until you enumerate it (foreach, .ToList(), .Count()). This enables composing queries without materializing intermediate results.

A10 Annotate test methods with [Fact] or

Optimization

Annotate test methods with [Fact] or [Theory] with [InlineData]. Use Mock<IService>() to create a mock. Setup behavior with mock.Setup(s => s.GetData()).Returns(fakeData). Pass mock.Object to the class under test. Assert with Assert.Equal, Assert.Throws.